Spencer Perceval — Speech

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> Над трудными словами написано, как их произносить. ЗАГЛАВНЫМИ буквами выделен ударный слог.

Slide 1 — Spencer Perceval

Good morning! My name is Matvey (мат-ВЕЙ) Kozubenko (ко-зу-БЕН-ко), and today I want to tell you about a British Prime (прайм) Minister (МИ-ни-стэ) you have probably never heard of: Spencer (СПЕН-сэ) Perceval (ПЁР-си-вэл). This portrait (ПОО-трэйт) was painted in 1812, the year he died. His name is not famous, but his story is like a detective (ди-ТЕК-тив) film.

Slide 2 — "He never walked out"

Imagine (и-МЭ-джин) this. London, the eleventh (и-ЛЕ-вэнс) of May, 1812. It is a quarter (КУОО-тэ) past five in the evening. The Prime (прайм) Minister (МИ-ни-стэ) of Great Britain walks into the Houses (ХАУ-зиз) of Parliament (ПАА-лэ-мэнт)... and he never walks out alive. This really happened. Spencer (СПЕН-сэ) Perceval (ПЁР-си-вэл) is the only British Prime (прайм) Minister (МИ-ни-стэ) in history who was assassinated (э-СЭ-си-нэй-тид). But first, who was he?

Slide 3 — Who was Spencer Perceval?

Spencer (СПЕН-сэ) Perceval (ПЁР-си-вэл) was born in London in 1762. His father was an earl (ёрл), but Spencer was a younger son, so he did not get the family fortune (ФОО-чун). He had to work. He studied at Trinity (ТРИ-ни-ти) College (КО-лидж), Cambridge (КЕЙМ-бридж), and became a very good lawyer (ЛОЙ-э). He had twelve children. He was small and thin, so people called him "Little P".

Slide 4 — The road to Downing Street

кэ-РИЭ ПАА-лэ-мэнт
His career moved step by step. In 1796 he became a Member of Parliament. In 1802 he

э-ТЁ-ни ДЖЕ-нэ-рэл ГА-вэн-мэнтс ЛОЙ-э ЧААН-сэ-лэ
became Attorney General, the government's main lawyer. In 1807 he became Chancellor

ов зэ икс-ЧЕ-кэ ФАЙ-нэнс прайм МИ-ни-стэ
of the Exchequer, the minister of finance. And in 1809 he became Prime Minister.

ИН-трэ-стинг ЧААН-сэ-лэ
Interesting fact: he kept the job of Chancellor too, so he did two top jobs at the same

time. Less than three years later, at just 49, his life ended.

Slide 5 — A hard time to lead Britain

прайм МИ-ни-стэ
He became Prime Minister at a very difficult time. First, Britain was at war with

нэ-ПОУ-ли-эн ПЁР-си-вэл дьюк ов УЭ-линг-тэн
Napoleon. Perceval supported the Duke of Wellington, who was fighting the French in

ПОО-чу-гэл джордж зэ сёрд
Spain and Portugal. Second, King George the Third became mentally ill, and in 1811 his

принс РИИ-джент ОО-ди-нэ-ри
son became Prince Regent. Third, life was hard for ordinary people. Food was expensive,

ЛА-дайтс мэ-ШИИНЗ
and some workers, called Luddites, broke machines in factories. Many people were angry

ГА-вэн-мэнт ПЁР-си-вэл
with the government. But the man who killed Perceval had a very personal reason.

Slide 6 — John Bellingham

БЕ-лин-гэм ПОО-трэйт МЁ-чэнт
His name was John Bellingham, and this is his portrait. He was a British merchant who

ар-КАН-гелск э-КЬЮЗД
worked in Arkhangelsk. Yes, here in Russia! After a business conflict, he was accused of

дэт
debt and spent about five years in Russian prisons. Nobody helped him. When he finally

ГА-вэн-мэнт ком-пэн-СЕЙ-шн
came back to England, he asked the government for compensation. Again and again, the

БЕ-лин-гэм ГА-вэн-мэнт ПЁР-си-вэл
answer was "no". Bellingham decided that the government, and its leader Perceval, was

рис-ПОН-сэ-бл РУУ-ин
responsible for his ruin.

Slide 7 — The day of the murder

БЕ-лин-гэм ПИС-тлз ТЕЙ-лэ
Bellingham prepared carefully. He bought two pistols and asked a tailor to sew a secret

и-ЛЕ-вэнс ЛО-би хаус ов
pocket inside his coat. On the eleventh of May he waited in the lobby of the House of

КО-мэнз КУОО-тэ ПЁР-си-вэл БЕ-лин-гэм
Commons. At about a quarter past five Perceval walked in. Bellingham stepped forward

ПЁР-си-вэл МЁ-дэд
and shot him in the chest. Perceval cried “I am murdered!” and fell. He died within

БЕ-лин-гэм
minutes. And Bellingham? He did not run away. He calmly sat down on a bench and

э-РЕС-тид
waited to be arrested.

Slide 8 — Justice in one week

ин-КРЕ-дэ-бли ТРАЙ-эл фиф-ТИИНС
Justice was incredibly fast. The trial took place just four days later, on the fifteenth of

БЕ-лин-гэм ГИЛ-ти ГА-вэн-мэнт
May. Bellingham said he was not guilty, because the government had wronged him. His

ЛОЙ-эз ин-СЕЙН
lawyers also said he was insane, but the court did not accept this. He was hanged on the

эй-ТИИНС эк-си-КЬЮ-шн
eighteenth of May. From the crime to the execution, only one week. Today many

хис-ТОО-ри-энз ТРАЙ-эл
historians think the trial was too fast to be fair.

Slide 9 — 1997: the families meet again

ФЕЙ-вэ-рит
And now my favourite part. 185 years later, in 1997, there was a general election in

ПАА-лэ-мэнт БЕ-лин-гэм РЕ-лэ-тив э-СЭ-син
Britain. A Member of Parliament called Henry Bellingham, a relative of the assassin, lost

КЭН-ди-дэт РО-джэ ПЁР-си-вэл
his seat. And he lost by fewer votes than another candidate won: Roger Percival, a

РЕ-лэ-тив МЁ-дэд прайм МИ-ни-стэ ПЁР-си-вэлз
relative of the murdered Prime Minister! Some people joked that it was Perceval’s

ри-ВЕНДЖ
revenge.

Slide 10 — Why remember Spencer Perceval?

So why should we remember Spencer (СПЕН-сэ) Perceval (ПЁР-си-вэл)? First, he is still the only British Prime (прайм) Minister (МИ-ни-стэ) who was assassinated (э-СЭ-си-нэй-тид). The murder shocked the whole country: people even bought jugs and mugs with pictures of it, like this one. Second, he was an honest man: he left his big family almost no money, so Parliament (ПАА-лэ-мэнт) gave his widow (УИ-доу) and children fifty thousand (ТАУ-зэнд) pounds. Third, today a plaque (плаак) in Parliament (ПАА-лэ-мэнт), in St (сэнт) Stephen's (СТИИ-вэнз) Hall (хол), shows the place where he fell.

Slide 11 — Thank you!

That's all from me. Thank you for listening! Do you have any questions?